RESOLUTION No. 4358

Designation of Jefferson High School as a Focus High School with a Middle College Program; Guaranteed Dual Assignment for Students in the Jefferson Attendance Area to a Comprehensive High School

October 12, 2010

RECITALS

A. Over the last two years, under the leadership of the Board of Education ("Board"), Portland Public Schools ("District") has engaged in an in-depth analysis of its high school system with the goal of improving its high schools to ensure better academic outcomes for all students. This process has involved input from thousands of students, staff members, families and citizens.
B. The high school system design effort has been guided by a set of goals identified by principals, teachers, parents and community leaders, including increasing the graduation rate, closing the achievement gap, inspiring and engaging all students, ensuring all schools are in high demand, and preparing all students for success at the next level.
C. The need for the high school system design process was driven both by the chronically inadequate academic results for many students across our high school system, as measured by graduation rate, the achievement gap, and college persistence and the current inequity in access to course offerings between high schools. Another driver was declining high school enrollment, 99 which has dropped by over 2,500 students since 2001. In addition, the current economic downturn further restricts the resources of the District. The District cannot afford to maintain the current portfolio of schools given the severe and continuing decline in funding for public education. Under these circumstances, The District must deliver academic services in a fiscally sustainable manner that also provides greater equity and consistency in access to a core program and that reduces the achievement gap that currently exists in every high school.
D. On March 8, 2010, by way of Resolution No. 4236, the Board directed the Superintendent to recommend a high school system design plan that would
    a. Reduce the number of current high school campuses with neighborhood attendance boundaries,
    b. Guarantee a common core program for each of the community comprehensive schools, and
    c. Establish enrollment parity across the community comprehensive schools.
E. On April 26, 2010, the Superintendent recommended a detailed high school system design plan, and after a 30-day public comment period, presented an amended plan to the Board on June 2, 2010. Following further discussion and additional citizen comment, the Superintendent stated that she would bring a revised proposal to the Board following the summer recess.
F. On September 27, 2010, the Superintendent presented her revised plan. In Resolution Nos. 4236 and 4357, the Board endorsed the framework of the high school system design plan, including the following key components:

a. The high school system will contain seven community comprehensive high schools with neighborhood attendance boundaries and a system of focus and education options schools.
b. Every student shall have access to the courses needed to meet District diploma requirements at a community comprehensive, focus, or education options high school. Through the community comprehensive high schools, every student will also have access to a core program that may include visual and performing arts, at least two world languages, advanced courses in each core area, a rigorous college level program, courses to meet Oregon University System admissions standards, career-related learning, and academic support courses. Focus and education options schools will not necessarily provide all of the elements above, because their program will be designed around a specific focus and students will elect to attend these schools.
c. Career-technical education ("CTE") and career exploration opportunities will be available at Benson Polytechnic High School, our other focus schools, and the community comprehensive high schools. The Superintendent will bring recommendations back to the Board by December 2010 for Benson and Spring 2011 for the community comprehensives.
d. The enrollment and transfer system will support enrollment stability and parity among the community comprehensive high schools.

G. Under the Superintendent's plan, Jefferson High School will operate as a focus high school with a middle college program that will have strong ties to the Jefferson neighborhood. Students in the Jefferson attendance boundary will have dual assignment to Jefferson or one of the neighboring comprehensive programs at Grant, Madison, or Roosevelt.
H. H. Students entering Jefferson as 9th-graders in 2011-12 will be required to participate in the Middle College program. When academically ready, they will enroll in a minimum number of Portland Community College ("PCC") or Portland State University dual-credit courses during their high school years. At least some of these dual-credit courses will be offered on the PCC-Cascade campus alongside other adult learners. As part of building a college-oriented culture and to support all students not ready to access college-level coursework, Jefferson will offer the Advancement Via Individual Determination ("AVID") program for freshmen entering in Fall 2011 or a program with similar proven results, will commit to prioritizing staffing for academic support courses and interventions within the school day, and will expand its partnerships with community providers to provide extended-day and extended-year academic support services. Jefferson will prioritize college-preparatory and career-interest electives within its elective program, such as biotechnology or health services. Jefferson will continue to have an athletic program for boys' and girls' teams; the number and type of teams will depend on student interest.
I. During Fall 2010, the Superintendent and her staff will continue to accelerate the work of two Jefferson work teams:
    a. A Jefferson Community Program Advisory Team. This team will build on the existing Jefferson community group that has advised the Superintendent during

Spring and Summer 2010, including representatives from the Jefferson cluster feeder schools' parent groups, while adding the voices of current Jefferson teachers and administrative staff. The Jefferson Community Program Advisory Team will give overall guidance about Jefferson's academic programs, community outreach, and partnerships. This team will coordinate with the Career Technical Education workgroup to ensure alignment of the recommendations for Jefferson's core programs and partnerships.

b. A PPS-PCC Middle College/Dual Credit Planning Team. This team will have the specific charge of expanding and identifying resources to support the Middle College Program and expanded dual credit opportunities at the Jefferson campus.

J. By January 2011, the Superintendent will present to the Board a proposal to establish the Harriet Tubman Leadership Academy for Young Women as an independent program with recommendations as to school or program status, grade configuration, and curriculum and program focus.

RESOLUTION

1. The Board directs the Superintendent to establish a focus high school with a middle college program on the Jefferson campus. The program at Jefferson will include dual-credit classes with PCC, academic support classes, extended day opportunities, and athletic offerings.
2. Students living in the current Jefferson attendance boundary will be guaranteed enrollment at Jefferson or at a specific nearby community comprehensive high school, whichever they choose. The Board directs the Superintendent to immediately initiate a process so that no later than December 30, 2010, the Board can vote to establish the community comprehensive high school – Grant, Madison, or Roosevelt – to which each student within the Jefferson attendance will be assigned. As Boise-Eliot is a school that historically has fed into Jefferson, students in the BoiseEliot attendance boundary will also be given dual assignment to Jefferson, as well as the current assignment to Grant.

Z. Smith